

course one for performance enhancing drugs. She looked at me and gave me a sociable smile; sensing a chance here (misplaced), the ad for the drugs jumped up two spots and sweetened the deal with a twenty per cent discount coupon valid for the next five minutes. What the AD succeeded in doing, was kill any traces of arousal I might have had, automatically dismissing the other advertisements. The one for the pills, however, shone brighter still! I hated this piece of crap and waved off the AD, irritation evident on my face. The shapely neighbor read this wrong and thought I was waving her off, her eyes going cold and distant...

I reached for the box before I could do more damage and bought it inside to check out its contents.

First: scan the tags, check out its transit history, look for any obvious red flags. None. Good.

Next: the opening. I stabbed the box eagerly and tore off the top; inelegant but efficient. Two inches of packaging foam later, I hit paydirt. Or not. Diapers. For grown ass men. The box was filled with grandpa-pants!

This was going to be one of those days... Sensing my growing unrest, OdinVision put on some soothing Blues to calm my nerves and tried to bring some cheer to this morning. It turned on the entertainment zone: my main wall came alive with 82-inches of Cartoon Network and my dining table slowly poured me some of my favourite social feeds and commentary that it thought I might find interesting. I appreciated the music but was not in the mood for cartoons. I gestured at the wall and the giant screen that was erstwhile blaring cartoons, powered-down and blended in with the rest of my wall by adapting the colour and pattern of my

CROWDSOURCING ENERGY



Excess body heat combined with piezoelectricity can also be used on a large scale to crowdsource energy. The Central Station in Stockholm sees more than 300,000 commuters pass through its doors each day. Each person generates about 100W of excess body heat. The station uses giant heat exchanges to trap this excess heat, warm up vats of water (thus aiding in cooling the station itself), and then pipe the warm water to a building next door in order to heat it! Meanwhile in Japan... there are special piezoelectric tiles installed by the ticket turnstiles. Each time a commuter steps on these tiles, a small amount of electricity is generated. A person weighing 60kg would generate about 0.1W in the second it takes to step across the tile. However, add in the millions of people who cross the metros each day and the energy adds up: enough to power nearby electronic signboards, Christmas decorations during festivities or even the ticket counters themselves.

living room's wallpaper. I grabbed a cup of coffee and sat down by the table. A news feed caught my eye; it was an email notification – for the package's successful delivery. I placed the cup on the table and the surface surrounding the cup immediately went a dark, bright, red. The cup was a good dozen degrees hotter than what my palette was used to. I would have to wait a few minutes – the table gently suggested – and started a countdown to 120 seconds around the bottom of the cup – time enough for both the cup and my temper to cool down...

Warming my hands by the cup, I gazed at the email for a few seconds. The table got the message and cleared up the rest of the feeds to bring the email to fore. I scrolled through the text to jump to the courier's ID and photograph. I selected the area of

interest by drawing a circle in the air and then made a tearing away gesture at the selection. OdinVision took the hint, digitally transferred the ID and photo to my HUD, ran an OCR on the ID, converted it to editable text and offered to store it in my memory bank up in the cloud. I gave it my assent. I queried the whereabouts of the ID. OdinVision filled my field-of-view with an overlay of the city map, in three-dimensions and appropriately scaled down. A yellow dot indicated my current position, a green dot, moving, indicated my quarry. Briefly, I thought of giving the courier an old-fashioned voice-call. But the thought of wading through the inevitable advertisements and product placements to connect and finish the call quickly quelled that thought. I gestured at the green dot and zoomed in for a closer view. I tapped on Mr



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* Measurement of DirectX graphics performance compared to Intel HD 2500 integrated graphics.

